

New Joiner Onboarding Plan — 8 Weeks

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Overview

By day 60 the new joiner ships design-system work independently, with seven focus areas closed to a working level. The plan runs in four two-week phases, each ending in a deliverable you both review.

- **Who:** mid-level developer joining the Nebula design system team.
- **Gaps to close:** design system fundamentals, accessibility, testing and quality, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, AWS, YAML templates), latest Angular versions and the Angular 20 upgrade, AEM and AEM as a Cloud Service, AI tooling (GitHub MCP, Figma MCP, Figma Code Connect, Nebula design system MCP).
- **How to use it:** tick tasks as they finish, update the tracker after each weekly 1:1, and log notes in the check-in section. She owns the checklists; you own the ratings.

Rating scale (used in the tracker):

Level	Meaning
1 — Aware	Knows the concepts, needs step-by-step guidance
2 — Guided	Completes tasks with review and occasional pairing
3 — Independent	Delivers routine work alone, asks on edge cases
4 — Leading	Reviews others' work and suggests improvements

Focus areas and baseline

Each gap targets level 3 (Independent) by day 60, except AEM at level 2 given its size. Fill in the baseline in week 1 from a short self-assessment plus your own observation.

Gap	What "good" looks like by day 60	Baseline (wk 1)	Target (day 60)
Design system fundamentals	Uses and extends tokens correctly, designs a component API, writes usage docs		3
Accessibility	Builds to WCAG 2.2 AA, tests with keyboard and a screen reader, fixes axe findings		3
Testing and quality	Writes unit, interaction and visual regression tests; follows the team's test strategy		3
CI/CD: GitHub Actions, AWS, YAML templates	Reads and edits our workflows, builds with reusable workflows and composite actions, explains how the pipeline authenticates to and deploys on AWS and how secrets are stored and read (AWS Secrets Manager); cuts a release with support		3
Angular (current version, v22) and the Angular 20 upgrade	Explains what changed across recent versions — standalone components, signals, built-in control flow, deferrable views, zoneless change detection, the esbuild/Vite builder — writes new code in that style, and delivers her part of the Angular 20 upgrade		3
AEM and AEM as a Cloud Service	Understands how Nebula components reach AEM (components, templates, client libraries, author vs publish) and how Cloud Manager pipelines deploy them		2

Gap	What "good" looks like by day 60	Baseline (wk 1)	Target (day 60)
AI tooling: GitHub MCP, Figma MCP, Figma Code Connect, Nebula MCP	Uses GitHub MCP and Figma MCP in daily work, maps Nebula components to Figma with Code Connect, and uses the Nebula design system MCP to find and apply components and tokens		3

Phase plan

Four phases move her from setup to owning a feature; each ends with a deliverable reviewed in the 1:1.

Phase 1 — Foundations (weeks 1-2)

Goal: running locally, knows the people, codebase and ways of working; baseline agreed.

- ☐ Access, local setup and first successful build of the design system repo
- ☐ Meet key contacts: design lead, a consuming product team, platform/CI owner
- ☐ Read the design system principles, contribution guide and component docs
- ☐ Walk through token architecture (primitive → semantic → component) with a senior
- ☐ Complete self-assessment against the four gaps; agree baseline ratings
- ☐ Angular: confirm which version our apps run and walk through what changed up to v22 — standalone components, signals, @if/@for control flow, deferrable views, zoneless, esbuild/Vite builder
- ☐ CI/CD: read the repo's GitHub Actions workflows and shared YAML templates; draw the path from PR to release
- ☐ AEM: overview session on how Nebula components are used in AEM — components, templates, client libraries, author vs publish
- ☐ AI tooling: set up GitHub MCP, Figma MCP and the Nebula design system MCP in her editor; short demo of how the team uses each
- ☐ Angular 20 upgrade: read the upgrade plan and tickets; run `ng update` on a branch to see what breaks
- ☐ Pair on one small bug fix and merge it through the full review flow
- ☐ **Deliverable:** first merged PR + a one-page "how our repo works" note in her own words

Phase 2 — Guided contribution (weeks 3–4)

Goal: delivers small changes with review; starts closing accessibility and testing gaps.

- ☐ Complete an accessibility primer: WCAG 2.2 AA essentials, ARIA patterns for common components
- ☐ Audit one existing component with keyboard, screen reader and axe; log findings
- ☐ Fix one accessibility issue from the audit, with tests
- ☐ Learn the test stack: unit, interaction and visual regression; add missing tests to one component
- ☐ Shadow a release: watch CI, versioning and changelog steps end to end
- ☐ Angular: refactor one component to signal inputs and the new control flow, with tests
- ☐ CI/CD: add or change one job in a GitHub Actions workflow (e.g. an a11y or visual test step) using a reusable workflow or composite action
- ☐ AEM: run the AEM as a Cloud Service SDK locally and deploy a component to the local author instance
- ☐ Angular 20 upgrade: take one scoped slice (a library or app) through the upgrade with a senior and fix its breaking changes
- ☐ AWS secrets: walk through how secrets are created, rotated and read from AWS Secrets Manager by GitHub Actions and our apps — never committed to YAML
- ☐ Figma Code Connect: connect one Nebula component to its Figma counterpart and check the snippet in Dev Mode
- ☐ **Deliverable:** accessibility audit write-up + fix PR with tests
- ☐ **Day-30 review** (see check-in section)

Phase 3 — Growing independence (weeks 5–6)

Goal: builds a component change alone, from API to docs.

- ☐ Draft a component API proposal (props, variants, tokens used) and get it reviewed
- ☐ Implement it with tokens, theming support and accessibility built in
- ☐ Write unit, interaction and visual regression tests to team standard
- ☐ Write usage docs and examples for the component
- ☐ Investigate one CI or build issue and present the fix or finding
- ☐ Angular: build the phase component zoneless-ready, using signals and deferrable views where they fit
- ☐ CI/CD: walk through the AWS side — accounts and environments, how GitHub Actions authenticates to AWS, what each deploy job changes
- ☐ AEM Cloud: walk through Cloud Manager — environments (dev, stage, prod), front-end vs full-stack pipelines, how a Nebula release reaches AEM

- ☐ Angular 20 upgrade: own one upgrade workstream independently, with tests passing
- ☐ AI tooling: build the phase component from its Figma design using Figma MCP and the Nebula MCP; note what the tools got right and wrong
- ☐ AWS secrets: add or update one secret used by a workflow, following the team's access process
- ☐ Review two teammates' PRs, leaving substantive comments
- ☐ **Deliverable:** component change merged with tests and docs

Phase 4 — Ownership (weeks 7-8)

Goal: owns a small feature end to end and contributes back to how the team works.

- ☐ Own a small feature or improvement from ticket to release
- ☐ Cut a release with a senior on hand (versioning, changelog, publish)
- ☐ AI tooling: use GitHub MCP for PRs, issues and reviews day to day; suggest one improvement to the Nebula MCP (docs, prompts or component metadata)
- ☐ Support a consuming team with a question or migration
- ☐ CI/CD: create or extend a reusable YAML workflow template used by more than one repo
- ☐ AEM Cloud: take a Nebula change through Cloud Manager to the dev environment with a senior on hand
- ☐ Angular 20 upgrade: land her part of the upgrade in main, with release notes, and list what moving to v22 would need next
- ☐ Improve one doc, test or tooling gap she hit during onboarding
- ☐ Present a 15-minute demo or knowledge share to the team
- ☐ **Deliverable:** released feature + team demo
- ☐ **Day-60 review** and plan for the next quarter

Progress tracker

Update one row after each weekly 1:1: rate each area 1-4 and set overall status. Two "At risk" weeks in a row means adjusting the plan, not pushing harder.

Week	Design system	A11y	Testing	CI/CD	Angular	AEM	AI tools	Phase deliverable	Status	Notes
1									▼	
2								First PR + repo note	▼	
3									▼	

Week	Design system	A11y	Testing	CI/CD	Angular	AEM	AI tools	Phase deliverable	Status	Notes
4								A11y audit + fix PR; Angular 20 slice upgraded	▼	
5									▼	
6								Component change merged	▼	
7									▼	
8								Released feature + demo; Angular 20 work in main	▼	

Check-ins and reviews

A 30-minute 1:1 each week, plus formal reviews at day 30 and day 60.

Weekly 1:1 agenda (copy per week):

1. What did you finish? Tick tasks in the phase plan.
2. What was hard or unclear? Which gap did it touch?
3. Ratings: agree this week's 1–4 per gap and update the tracker.
4. Blockers and support needed (pairing, access, time).
5. Focus for next week (top 2–3 items).

Day-30 review

- Has she merged at least two PRs through the full review flow?
- Are accessibility and testing at level 2 or above?
- What is her own view of progress versus yours? Note any gap.
- Adjust phases 3–4 if any gap is still at level 1.

Day-60 review

- Which gaps reached level 3? Which need a follow-up plan?
- Feedback from a teammate and a consuming team.
- Agree next-quarter goals and a growth area beyond these focus areas.

Notes log

Week	Key points	Actions	Owner
1			

Week	Key points	Actions	Owner
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Success criteria and resources

Onboarding is complete when every area reaches its target level and she has shipped a feature end to end.

Day-60 success criteria

- ☐ Every area at its target level (3, or 2 for AEM)
- ☐ At least one component change merged with tests and docs
- ☐ One release cut with support and one Nebula change deployed to AEM Cloud dev
- ☐ Gives useful PR reviews to teammates
- ☐ Her part of the Angular 20 upgrade merged to main
- ☐ Uses GitHub MCP, Figma MCP, Code Connect and the Nebula MCP in daily work
- ☐ Presented a demo or knowledge share to the team

Resources (add internal links)

Area	Resources
Design system fundamentals	Nebula principles and contribution guide; token architecture docs; component API guidelines
Accessibility	WCAG 2.2 quick reference; WAI-ARIA Authoring Practices Guide; axe DevTools; team a11y checklist
Testing and quality	Team test strategy; testing library docs; visual regression setup guide

Area	Resources
CI/CD	GitHub Actions docs on reusable workflows and composite actions; our shared YAML templates repo; AWS account and environment map; AWS Secrets Manager docs and our secrets access process; release and versioning runbook
Angular	angular.dev guides on signals, control flow and zoneless; Angular update guide (v20 path); our Angular 20 upgrade plan and tickets; team Angular conventions
AEM / AEM Cloud	Adobe Experience League AEM as a Cloud Service docs; AEM SDK local setup guide; Cloud Manager pipeline docs; our AEM integration notes
AI tooling	GitHub MCP server setup guide; Figma MCP server docs; Figma Code Connect docs; Nebula design system MCP README and usage examples

Buddy: assign a senior teammate for day-to-day questions, separate from your 1:1s.